Apex Systems

Response to Request for Proposal — Enterprise Procurement Evaluation Platform

Executive Summary

Apex Systems is a specialist enterprise software integrator with 14 years of experience delivering large-scale digital transformation programs for regulated industries including financial services, healthcare, and government. We propose a robust, secure, cloud-native platform architecture purpose-built for high-assurance procurement evaluation workloads.

Our proposal emphasizes technical depth, security-by-design, and a proven delivery methodology refined across more than 40 enterprise engagements.

Understanding of Requirements

We understand the organization requires a secure, multi-tenant evaluation platform capable of ingesting supplier proposals, applying configurable weighted criteria, and producing auditable, defensible rankings. The platform must integrate with existing ERP and identity systems, support 5,000+ concurrent users at peak procurement cycles, and satisfy stringent security and compliance requirements given the sensitivity of commercial data involved.

Proposed Solution

Apex proposes a microservices architecture deployed on Kubernetes, with event-driven integration via Kafka and a dedicated API gateway. Core services include document ingestion, evaluation orchestration, scoring, and reporting, each independently scalable. All data is encrypted at rest using AES-256 and in transit using TLS 1.3. Pre-built integration adapters are available for SAP and Oracle ERP suites, and the platform exposes a REST and GraphQL API for custom integrations.

Comprehensive audit logging captures every scoring decision, user action, and system event for a minimum retention period of seven years, supporting full traceability for procurement audits.

Implementation Approach

We follow a five-phase delivery methodology: Discovery, Design, Build, User Acceptance Testing, and Hypercare. Each phase concludes with a formal client sign-off gate. A dedicated integration sprint is scheduled early in the program specifically to de-risk legacy ERP connectivity, which we have identified as the primary technical risk for this engagement.

Timeline

Phase	Duration	Key Deliverable
Discovery	4 weeks	Requirements sign-off, integration inventory
Design	5 weeks	Architecture blueprint, security design review
Build	16 weeks	Core platform, integrations, reporting
UAT	6 weeks	Client acceptance testing, defect resolution

Hypercare	5 weeks	Go-live support, knowledge transfer

Team Structure

• Program Director — overall accountability and executive escalation point

• Solution Architect — platform architecture and integration design authority

• 4x Senior Software Engineers — core platform and integration build

• Security Engineer — dedicated to threat modeling and control implementation

• QA Lead — test strategy, automation, and UAT coordination

• Change Manager — training, adoption, and organizational readiness

Milestones

Milestone	Target Week	Exit Criteria
Requirements Sign-off	Week 4	Signed requirements traceability matrix
Architecture Approval	Week 9	Security and architecture review passed
Core Platform Complete	Week 18	All core services deployed to staging
Integrations Complete	Week 25	ERP integrations validated end-to-end
UAT Sign-off	Week 31	Client acceptance criteria met
Go-Live	Week 36	Production cutover complete

Price Table

Line Item	Amount (USD)
Discovery & Design	$180,000
Implementation	$620,000
Testing & QA	$95,000
Training & Change Management	$60,000
Year 1 Support & Maintenance	$150,000
Total (Year 1)	$1,105,000

Pricing Assumptions

Pricing assumes a fixed-price engagement for the scope defined in Appendix A, standard business hours support during implementation, and excludes third-party software licensing costs. Change requests outside the agreed scope are billed at $185/hour under our standard change control process. Pricing is valid for 60 days from proposal submission.

Security Controls

Apex Systems is SOC 2 Type II certified and ISO 27001 certified. All data is encrypted using AES-256 at rest and TLS 1.3 in transit. We conduct quarterly third-party penetration testing and maintain a dedicated 24/7 Security Operations Center. Access control is enforced via role-based access control (RBAC) with mandatory SSO/SAML integration. Annual third-party security audits are performed and results are available to clients under NDA.

Compliance Information

Our platform is GDPR and CCPA compliant, with a HIPAA-ready architecture available for healthcare clients. Data residency controls allow clients to specify the geographic region for data storage. A complete, immutable audit trail is retained for a minimum of seven years to support regulatory and internal audit requirements.

Risks

Key risk: integration complexity with legacy ERP systems. Mitigation: a dedicated integration sprint and sandbox environment are scheduled in the first six weeks of the program to surface and resolve integration issues early.

Key risk: resource ramp-up delays. Mitigation: our senior delivery team is pre-allocated and available to start within two weeks of contract signature.

Support Model

24/7 Tier 1-3 support with a guaranteed 1-hour response time for Severity 1 incidents and 4-hour response for Severity 2. Clients are assigned a dedicated Customer Success Manager and participate in quarterly business reviews to assess platform performance and roadmap alignment.

Relevant Experience

Apex Systems delivered a comparable evaluation and workflow platform for a top-10 U.S. bank supporting over 2,000 concurrent users. We also implemented a secure document evaluation system for a national healthcare network and a supplier evaluation platform for a state government procurement agency, both of which remain in production today.

References

• Jordan Whitfield, VP of Procurement, FinCorp Holdings (fictional reference) — available on request

• Priya Nandakumar, CTO, Meridian Health Network (fictional reference) — available on request

• Marcus Delaney, Director of IT, State Procurement Agency (fictional reference) — available on request